

MS Office 2013 lookalike: Nitro PDF

Open Source Softwares

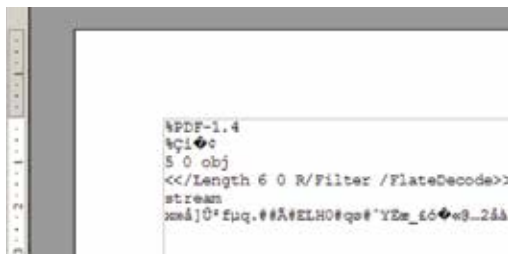
OpenOffice, initially developed under Sun Microsystems, later donated to the Apache Foundation and now released under the name Apache OpenOffice; and LibreOffice, developed by The Document Foundation, and forked and derived from OpenOffice itself, are two Open Source Software products considered to be handy substitutes for Acrobat, Nitro and even Microsoft Office. Comparing the two, though, is like comparing two siblings, for both are somewhat based on the same source code. Users find many similarities and trivial differences, if any, in both. For instance, both the suites can be traced back to openoffice.org (an open source initiative which was shut down in 2011).

But if we delve further, it is pretty evident that LibreOffice has recently gone through some major cosmetic and technical changes. While both the suites use the “Draw” application to edit PDFs, OpenOffice needs an additional plug-in to open and edit them. Known as the PDF import extension, it’s essential for PDF editing, because without it, the information in the document will be unrecognizable to you and will somewhat look like the accompanying illustration. In addition, it is understood that an open source software flourishes on inputs provided by the community, and going by the sheer strength of contributors to its repositories, the scales are tipped in the favor of LibreOffice. Unless these figures alter quickly, OpenOffice is unlikely to stay in competition, no matter how dedicated its existing developers are.

One more advantage LibreOffice has over all the other contenders is that it comes pre-installed in most of the Linux distros. Even Adobe doesn’t provide distribution of Acrobat (for the purpose of editing and authoring



LibreOffice welcome screen



A PDF document in Apache OpenOffice without the PDF Import Extension